



King County Library System

Director's Report – December 2025

Public Services

Library Outreach, Programs and Services (LOPS)

KCLS wrapped up its successful Author Voices series with a visit from horror author Stephen Graham Jones at the Auburn Library on Nov. 7. The after-hours event drew 110 attendees and was viewed simultaneously online by another 208 people. The program is still available to watch on KCLS' YouTube channel: *Author Voices: In Conversation with Stephen Graham Jones*.

Our libraries are offering a variety of events to brighten the season. The Covington Library hosted Ensemble Ballet Theatre for a performance of highlights from *The Nutcracker*, drawing 300 patrons of all ages. The Renton Library held a popular gingerbread house-making program with 145 participants. The Dickens Carolers are also performing at four locations this year: Algona-Pacific, Mercer Island, Lake Forest Park and Newcastle. More information is available in our online Events Calendar.

The Library Outreach Programs and Services team is collaborating with the Communications and Marketing, and Equity and Social Impact Departments to plan 2026 programming. Early discussions include next year's Summer Reading Program and two new adult reading campaigns designed to build excitement around library resources and champion books and reading.

Equity and Social Impact



On Saturday Dec. 6 the Equity and Social Impact (ESI) Department hosted its Plaza Comunitaria program graduation ceremony at the Bellevue Library. Plaza Comunitaria is an adult education program in Spanish that helps participants complete their primary and secondary education through a partnership with the Mexican Consulate and INEA (the National Institute for Adult Education/Instituto Nacional de la Educación para el Adulto), part of the Mexican government's education department.



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Plaza Comunitaria students are Spanish-speaking adults who did not have the opportunity to complete their education in their countries of origin. The program allows them to attend classes in person or online and earn their diplomas with the support of tutors and volunteers, often while balancing work and family responsibilities. Saturday's ceremony celebrated two graduates and was attended by Victor Hugo López, Consul Titular of the Mexican Consulate, as well as KCLS Foundation Executive Director Lisa Yamasaki, both of whom shared remarks. The KCLS Foundation generously sponsored the food and music for the event.

This graduation marked the conclusion of KCLS' Plaza Comunitaria program after 10 years, due to shifting community needs, geographical and logistical constraints and declining enrollment. Students who are still working toward graduation are being transitioned into other Plaza Comunitaria programs offered in King County through partner organizations and the Mexican Consulate. The ESI Department is grateful for the Foundation's long-standing support and is gathering community feedback from Spanish-speaking residents to identify new pathways for adult education programs in our service area.

Government Relations

With the November election results certified, KCLS staff and I attended recognition events for the outgoing mayors of Des Moines, Duvall, Enumclaw and Issaquah, as well as the swearing-in ceremonies of King County Executive Girmay Zahilay and King County Councilmember Steffanie Fain.

I met with Renton Mayor Armando Pavone and learned about Renton's plans for a social services hub, modeled after the successful Auburn hub. Library staff will be able to refer patrons to the hub for food assistance, housing support, mental health services and other critical resources. This continues my ongoing city leadership meetings to ensure our community libraries are aware of and supporting partner cities' social service goals. I also joined city, county and regional elected officials for a preview ride of the Sound Transit Federal Way Extension light rail, now running south from the airport with three new stops in Des Moines and Federal Way.

Administrative Services

Human Resources

KCLS launched KCLS Alerts on Nov. 18, 2025; it is a new emergency notification system designed to quickly reach employees when building operations or safety are impacted. The system provides multichannel messaging - including work email and cell notifications - to ensure timely communication during events such as weather closures, lockdowns or building-wide safety issues. Staff may also opt in with personal devices for added convenience.

On Dec. 3, 2025, KCLS Board of Trustees members Laura Valenziano and Crystal Goodwin, along with Executive Director Heidi Daniel, celebrated 116 staff members marking milestone anniversaries of 10



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or more years of service at the annual Service Awards event. The theme, "Together We Shine," highlighted how each honoree brings skills, compassion and creativity to KCLS, and how their collective efforts create something extraordinary for patrons and the community. Surrounded by colleagues, friends and family, each honoree received a small token of appreciation, and the celebration concluded with lunch, socializing and photos.



Heidi Daniel addressing the audience at the annual KCLS Service Award Reception

Information Technology Services (ITS)

KCLS leaders met with Microsoft Elevate to explore potential partnership opportunities, focusing on their training offerings and discussing Reading Coach as a promising tool to support literacy efforts. This conversation is part of Microsoft's broader goal to develop a cohort of libraries that will evaluate use cases and identify where Microsoft solutions - such as Reading Coach - can address library needs.



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Communications and Marketing



Redmond librarians Lisa Racine and Hope Yeats

KCLS launched the annual Best Books campaign to highlight this year's favorite books selected by staff across the system, featuring coordinated social media, advertising and in-library content. The campaign also produced several viral videos, including the first TikTok to reach 100,000 views and an Instagram video with 150,000 views. Overall, our social media follower count has grown by nearly 50% this year.

KCLS Foundation

Love Letters to Libraries

The Foundation's campaign to inspire community engagement and support for KCLS and the Foundation kicks off Dec. 15. All libraries in our service area and mobile service routes, along with several schools and businesses, will offer letter templates and collection boxes where patrons and community members can write letters of appreciation to our libraries. The goal is to collect 3,000 letters before the campaign ends Jan. 16.

These letters will be displayed as an exhibit at the March 7 Literary Lions Gala. Follow along and share the opportunity at <https://www.kclsfoundation.org/loveletters>.



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Giving Tuesday

The Foundation raised \$56,000—surpassing its \$50,000 goal—during the annual Giving Tuesday campaign, which took place on Dec. 2 this year. Giving Tuesday is a one-day, global fundraising event that follows Black Friday and Cyber Monday and encourages the public to support nonprofits as part of their holiday giving.

Here are a few notes received with donations:

"The first library I ever entered at like 4 or 5 was the OG Maple Valley location before it moved! I attended the ribbon-cutting ceremony for the updated Maple Valley location where still resides. Great memories, happy to contribute to more for others."

"KCLS has been here for me for 40+ years, an institution I'm very grateful my community has."

"To the King County Library System: Thank you for your tireless work as stewards of knowledge and champions of community. You are where learning begins, where curiosity thrives, and where every King County resident finds the tools to write their own success story. Your impact is truly priceless."

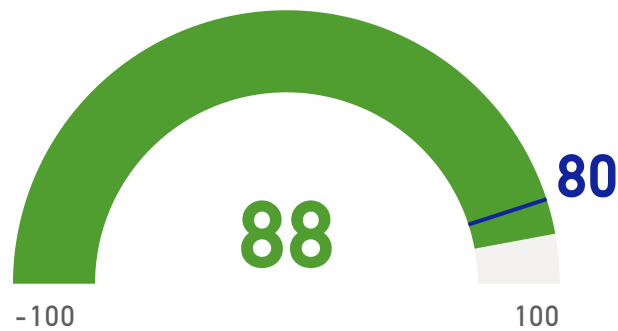
"In memory of D.R.S: Your love of reading and knowledge lives on in your beloved grandchildren who are now 5 and at the beginning of their own love of reading books and gaining knowledge."



Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

3-month rolling values for our KPIs: Net Promoter Score, the percentage of patrons who learned something new at a KCLS program, and the percentage of patrons who felt a sense of connection at a KCLS program.

Net Promoter Score



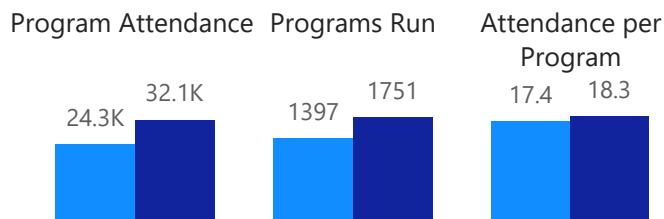
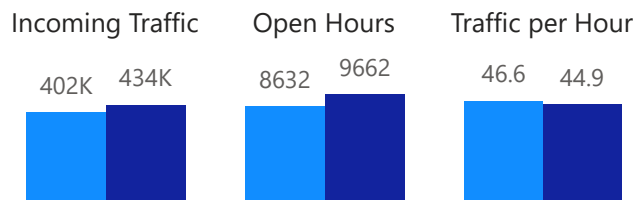
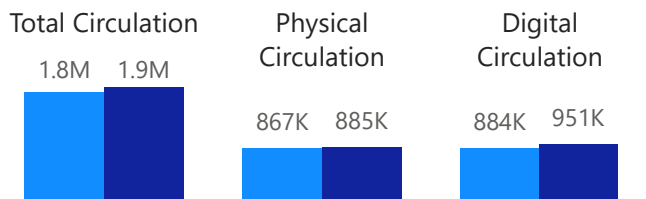
Learned Something New



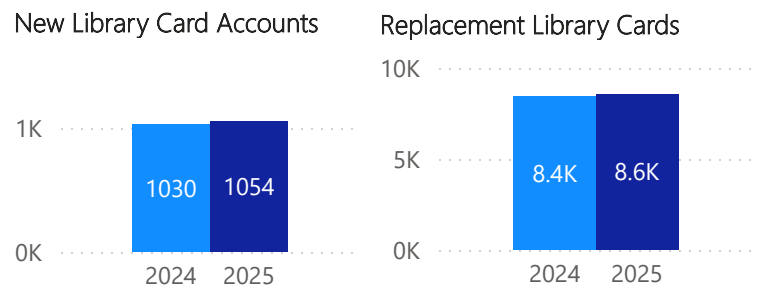
Felt Sense of Connection



System Usage - 2024 vs 2025



Cards & Accounts



Active Patrons & Market Penetration

Active Households include all addresses with at least one active patron. Market penetration is the number of active households against the total households in the KCLS service area. Active cardholders count patrons with library card activity in the given timeframes.

258.1K

1-Year Active Households

44.91%

Household Market Penetration

401.4K

1-Year Active Cardholders

466.7K

2-Year Active Cardholders